Evaluating a Flawed Dashboard

coursera
coursera

Scenario

You are an analyst at a market research firm that has recently rolled out a new dashboard to help account managers track client engagement. However, initial feedback is that the dashboard is confusing and hard to use. Your manager has tasked you with conducting a formal usability evaluation to identify the specific problems and recommend concrete improvements before it is deployed to the entire company. Your goal is to pinpoint the flaws that prevent users from quickly finding valuable insights.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this assessment, you will be able to:

- Evaluate a dashboard for common usability flaws and clarity issues.
- Analyze interactive features to determine their effectiveness in facilitating data exploration.
- Formulate actionable recommendations to improve a dashboard's design and user experience.

Instructions

Your Tasks

Setup: Familiarize yourself with the flawed sample dashboard and the structured evaluation template provided in the browser.

Instructions

Core Activity Steps:

1. Identify Usability Flaws: Systematically review the dashboard to identify at least three distinct usability issues related to layout, labeling, color use, or data hierarchy.
2. Assess Interactivity: Test all interactive elements, such as filters and clickable charts, to ensure they function as expected and support or hinder the discovery of insights.
3. Document Your Findings: Use the provided evaluation template to log each issue, describe its potential impact on a user, and classify its severity (e.g., high, medium, or low).

Instructions

Documentation: For each issue documented in your template, propose a clear, actionable solution that would resolve the problem and improve the user experience.

Submission Output

Submit the following as a single pdf document:

- **Completed Evaluation Template:** Your filled-out template detailing at least three usability flaws, their impact, and your specific recommendations for improvement.
- **Brief Reflection:** A short paragraph (4–6 sentences) identifying the single most critical issue you discovered. Explain why addressing this one flaw would provide the greatest improvement to the dashboard's overall effectiveness for an account manager.

Self-Assessment Checklist

- At least three distinct usability flaws are identified and documented in the template.
- The potential impact of each flaw on the user is clearly described.
- A specific, actionable recommendation is provided for each identified flaw.
- The reflection paragraph identifies the single most critical issue and justifies the choice.